

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Sahlah Sohail

Address: 58 Burdon Lane Cheam SM2 7BY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my support for planning application DM2025/01591.

As a doctor currently working within the NHS and living in Sutton, I see daily the pressures that many individuals and families face, particularly in relation to mental health, social isolation and access to supportive community networks. In clinical practice, we increasingly recognise that health outcomes are not determined by medical treatment alone, but also by social connection, belonging and preventative community engagement.

For the past three years, this congregation has already been gathering locally for prayer and community activities. These gatherings have taken place with minimal complaints and without significant disruption, demonstrating that the group operates in a considerate and responsible manner. The proposed community centre would simply provide a more suitable and structured environment for activities that are already established within the area.

From a healthcare perspective, accessible community spaces can have a measurable positive impact on mental wellbeing. They offer opportunities for peer support, reduce loneliness, provide routine and stability, and create safe spaces for discussion and guidance. Such protective factors are strongly associated with improved mental health outcomes and reduced strain on primary and secondary care services.

Importantly, a dedicated community facility would also create opportunities to deliver community health workshops. These could include sessions on mental health awareness, chronic disease prevention, healthy lifestyle education and support for carers and vulnerable groups. Bringing

health education directly into community settings improves engagement, particularly among populations who may be less likely to access traditional healthcare pathways.

Having worked within the NHS for many years, I am acutely aware of the importance of preventative and community-based interventions. In my view, this proposal aligns with those principles and would strengthen the local support infrastructure in Sutton.

For these reasons, I respectfully ask Sutton Council to approve planning application DM2025/01591.